



British-Backed School in Nairobi Slum Announces Registered Charity Status

Rossholme School in Kenya has officially launched as a charity, after being granted the registered charity number 1778553. The school in Nairobi's Kiambiu slum provides free, sound education and pastoral care for some 90 children aged 2 to 9, who would otherwise receive no formal teaching.

It is run by 30-year-old Kenyan Joyce Aruga, with the support of the UK-based charity, set up by Judith Webb, herself the former headmistress of Rossholme School in Somerset, which closed in 2005.

Joyce wants to give children the opportunities for which she herself had to fight. Raised on Lake Victoria, she was made to give up her schooling aged just 13 to enter a forced marriage with a 45-year-old man. She managed to flee the marriage and, after finding work as a maid in Nairobi, graduated as a teacher in July 2016.

Three years earlier she had met Judy at a conference in London hosted by the BBC World Service to launch its first list of 100 Women, which celebrated inspiring women from around the world. Following a successful military career, Judy spent 20 years as headmistress of Rossholme, the girls' school her family had run for 50 years. The two hit it off immediately and, after Joyce had graduated, the two set about realising Joyce's dream of providing education to kids from a background similar to hers.

The school currently needs about £500 per month to stay afloat, money used to rent the humble tin-roofed building in which it's housed, and to pay the teachers. It also needs money for breakfast and lunch food programmes, books, equipment, uniforms and other teaching materials. There are plans to expand its current scope. Forging links with schools in U.K. so that they can learn about life and learning in Kenya and raise funds would make such a difference to these deprived children.

For more information please contact:

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***Joyce Aruga** is the youngest of 11 children born on Lake Victoria, Kenya and the only one to attend school. She ran away from a forced marriage at 14 and finally graduated as a teacher in 2016 having been sponsored by the Methodist Church. 2 months later, she opened Rossholme with just 6 pupils. Now remarried, she has two adoptive children, a nephew aged 7 and a niece of 21*

***Judy Webb** was the first woman to command an all male field force unit in the British Army and, following her retirement as a major in 1986, she took over as Head of Rossholme School, a girls' school in Somerset. She was Chairman of Council for St John in Somerset (St John Ambulance) and when Rossholme School closed in 2005, she ran events, holiday lettings and wellness centre businesses. Married with 2 adult children, she lives in Somerset.*



ROSSHOLME SCHOOL IN KENYA

Registered Charity Number 1178553

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